

**PROLOGUE**

**INT. TERRACOTTA CUSTOMS AND SOIL PROTECTION OFFICE**

A polaroid camera snaps and prints a photo. The photo is of RAU RAM, 30s, a Cilantro whose earthly hair and tan gleam, but vermilion hands. Pregnant, she is expecting a new seed.

RAU (O.S.)  
Green Card?

Vermilion hands pull the photo off the camera.

RAU (O.S.) (CONT'D)  
Oh... a photo...

**THROUGH THE CAMERA:** RAU leans against a wall in a terracotta pot-esque Customs and Soil Protection (CSP) biometric office. She is underneath a banner that reads: "Photosynthesis."

RHIZO BLOMQUIST, a CSP Officer and eventual Secretary of Garden Security, takes the photo off RAU's hands and puts it in RAU RAM's case file. RAU has RHIZO display RAU's case file for us to see through the camera.

This 1995 Woodwork citizenship application shows that RAU was born in Vuon (Vietnamese: "Garden"), age 30s, a Cilantro ethnicity, a red leaf fingerprint, and a pending green card.

RAU extends a hand. RHIZO dismisses the handshake and exits.

RAU turns us (the camera) around to reveal...

**EXT. CAMERA STORE IN THE AIRPORT - DAY**

**THROUGH THE CAMERA:** ...a camera store where RAU made her first purchase: a polaroid camera and tripod! She already unboxed them and set them up. She takes her first own photo.

RAU  
Photosynthesis!

FLASH! RAU approaches and turns us (the camera) around to...

**EXT. DIRTY CITY - DAY**

**THROUGH THE CAMERA:** ...the welcome sign of Dirty City, Woodwork. She clumsily adjusts the camera and runs towards the welcome sign. She positions herself, trying to seem cool while the local plants walk by with scorn eyes.



RAU  
Photosynthesis!

SNAP! RAU runs to us and turns us (the camera) around to...

**EXT. DIRTY CITY - TOWN SQUARE - DAY**

**THROUGH THE CAMERA:** ...a bustling town square with a fountain. She runs towards the fountain.

RAU  
Photo-

CRACK! Someone knocked us (the camera) over.

**EXT. DIRTY CITY - STREET - EVENING**

RAU detaches the damaged camera from the tripod and carries the camera around, with a photo protruding.

She walks past sheer disapproval. RAU sees the locals put up signs that read: "Curb the Herb." With each unwelcoming gesture, she sinks lower. She does not belong on this soil.

**EXT. FIG LEAF - DUSK**

The sun sets as RAU collapses. RAU is too exhausted for tears. She finally pulls the photo out of the polaroid.

The photo is her pregnant belly. She is here for one reason.

RAU  
My seed...

MALUS (O.S.)  
Mercy?

RAU turns away from the sunset to face a vibrant nightclub.

The door opens, revealing an apple in their 40s named MALUS CRABAPPLE. Their red attire is fabulously angelic.

RAU  
*Chào*. Aren't you an angel?

MALUS  
*Hello*. Aren't all Figs?

RAU  
*Hell! Any Fig is a malice!*

MALUS  
Dat's my name: Malus Crabapple. I  
am a Fig-

MALUS extends a hand. RAU slaps it away, but they got her.

RAU  
Figment of my imagination. Get your  
appendages off me!

MALUS  
Reality! Gotta hand it to you. You  
are no angel. You ain't owed a safe  
haven. You don't belong on our soil.

RAU knocks down MALUS.

RAU  
Heavens. Your kind soiled safety.

MALUS  
Your kind of soil is mud.

RAU  
Mud is where you're most safe...  
*Stranger*.

MALUS stands. They show their green palms then closes them.

MALUS  
Dirty or clean... **A green card  
ain't green on the other side.**

RAU

Already better than growing up  
playing red cards I'm dealt with.

MALUS

But, the other side of the ocean  
had the right conditions for you.  
There ain't no unconditional love  
in our Dirty City.

RAU

The Woodwork dream...

MALUS

Is that what you imagined it to be?

RAU

This Cilantro dreams! *Bleeds!* I  
believe this city needs its  
garnishes. Imagine Dirty City's  
first-ever salon. I *know* of a  
better life for my family here...

MALUS

You immigrants got wild dreams. *But  
imaginations.* You cannot imagine my  
people living in peace with your  
family, wherever yours come from.

RAU

You don't know where I come from.

MALUS

Like a leaf, Figs are always  
floating around the world. Your  
tone ain't a *brussels* sprout's.

RAU

Well, your attitude is CRAP!

MALUS

Watch your language!

RAU

CACA! Pardon my French. I do not  
have a tone! I went to a Woodwork-  
sponsored school to get the Vuon  
out of my system...

MALUS

Well you *look* like you took a leave  
from Southeast Asia? All your last  
names are like weed (re: *Nguyen*)?

RAU

Răm. Rau Răm. Lots more last names  
in Vuon. And no. You know nothing  
about life out there.

MALUS

Rau, I ain't judge ya days. Don't  
judge my night-

RAU

I know not of where your nightlife  
comes from.

MALUS

It stems from birth.

RAU

You chose this light. This  
lifestyle you have, you are not  
born with it. You are not natural.  
I cannot imagine a life without  
light.

MALUS

You keep this up and your salon  
stays an imagination. Your story  
will end here.

RAU

I cannot keep my stems up. No plot  
of land in Dirty City will ever let  
me plant myself. I moved this far  
for what? My story will... What?

**"MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD" SONG**

MALUS walks over to the empty plot of land next door. They  
pull the tarp away to unveil fresh soil.

MALUS

MOVE THE PLOT... MOVE THE PLOT...  
FORWARD...  
MAKE YOUR ROOTS AT HOME.

RAU

THIS IS YOUR BEST FOOT FORWARD?

MALUS

ROOT FOR ME...

RAU

IM LANG (Vietnamese: "Shut up").

MALUS  
(Puzzledly)  
MAKE YOUR BED.  
A TANNING BED ROLLS OUT. OVER TIME,  
A SEEDLING GROWS NEARBY.

RAU  
SHUT UP.

MALUS  
I WASN'T BORN WITH LIGHTHEARTEDNESS.  
*I HAVE CHOSEN IT!*

NOW YOU CHOOSE:  
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD...

OR . . . ? RAU

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MALUS
LEAVE THE PLOT HOLE...
(Repeating)
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD...
LEAVE THE PLOT HOLE...

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RAU reluctantly plants herself.

WHOLE . . . RAU

RAU & MALUS  
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD...

FORWARD! RAU MALUS YOU'RE WHOLE!

**INT. SALONTRO - DAY**

The plot thickens. The empty plot of land quickly develops into the Salontro salon. An Open/Closed sign hangs. It faces "Closed." A tanning bed descends.

RAU  
Im lang. Im lang. Im lang! Im lang!

MALUS touches the tanning bed.

MALUS  
Imagine a better plot device.

RAU  
*Im lang.* The sun is more than all  
things, but a tanning bed will do.

MALUS

*Shut up. I cannot take anymore of  
your deep gratitude, foreigner.*

RAU

We bleed the same eukaryotic  
cells...

MALUS

Indeed, then treat me like I do.

RAU

But... how much does your wallet  
weigh?

MALUS

Greedy... You've got morals that  
need cleansing.

RAU

*Greens!* It's not greed for us  
Cilantros to have good taste! Do  
you have money on you?

MALUS

My business adheres to the capital  
and makes profits. So yes. What's  
your worth?

RAU

*That'd be ten B S, please...*

MALUS

*Dat's the start of a plot.*

MALUS hands a manure-laced bill to RAU. They hide in the  
tanning bed.

RAU

IT'S THE TURN OF AN ERA!  
I WAS DEALT A BAD HAND.  
THIS AREA HAS NO REGARD.  
THEY TREAT ME AS AN ALIEN.  
I HAVE GROWN THESE LEAVES THAT  
COULDN'T EVER HOLD THIS WATER.  
I WAS GONNA COME APART.  
BUT I GUESS YOU DO HAVE A HEART.  
I HAVE A NEW START.

MALUS gets out of the tanning bed.

RAU (CONT'D)

Turn around. Nice tan. Nothing  
fancy.

MALUS

Not a fan. You will see dat fancy  
gets the fans.

RAU goes out and gets a potted herb. She puts it on a shelf  
then turns the "Closed" sign to "Open."

MALUS (CONT'D)

I'll try to get my pals en root.  
You're on your own in this soil.  
It's all your turn from here.

MALUS exits. The MAYOR, dressed as a tumbleweed, dances in  
and out.

RAU

I CAN'T EARN MY GREEN CARD  
IF I DON'T STAY ON MY GUARD.  
MY LEAVES HAVE COME SO FAR.  
YOU CAN'T MAKE ME LEAVE!  
ALL THAT REMAINS ARE MY ROOTS,  
FAMILY...

I MISS YOU, BROTHER.

RAU hugs the pot. She sits on the tanning bed. She pulls out  
body oil and rubs her belly with it.

RAU (CONT'D)

Seems the most proper maternity  
gift is reality.

PARSLEY (V.O.)

(Echoing from the great  
beyond)

TURN AROUND!

Positive whispers are audible. FigLeaf patrons come in and  
out of Salontro. With the rising and setting sun, financial  
quarters roll by.

RAU

My body oil? You like this foreign  
stuff...? Well, it's no fertilizer!  
This oil is not found in Dirty  
City. It's from my dirty ol'  
village!

YOU HAVE MADE IT.  
TURN AWAY FROM YOUR OLD LIFE.  
YOUR BED IS MADE.  
TURN AWAY FROM THEIR WILD NIGHT.

THIS DIRTY CITY IS OUR HOME.

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)  
THE NEIGHBORS, THEY'LL KNOW  
TO STAY IN THEIR ZONE UNLESS THEIR  
TONES...  
TURN OVER AND CHANGE FOR THE  
BETTER.

Business is booming. More tanning beds roll out. Money rains down.

MALUS steps in, unimpressed with RAU's success.

|                              |                              |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| RAU (CONT'D)                 | MALUS                        |
| (Deceptively)                | (Doubtfully)                 |
| THIS IS THE START OF...      | THIS IS THE START OF...      |
| A BUSINESS PARTNERSHIP.      | A BUSINESS PARTNERSHIP.      |
| A "FRIENDSHIP" WHERE I CAN'T | A "FRIENDSHIP" THAT SOWS MAD |
| KEEP MY GUARD DOWN.          | SEEDS IN OUR GARDEN.         |

MALUS gathers money and leaves the rest to RAU. They exit.

RAU turns the sign to "Closed." She places the seedling in a lit tanning bed and closes its lid, then hides in another tanning bed.

RAU (CONT'D)  
BUT THE BEST TURNOVER I'VE EVER  
HAD...

RAU gets out. Her belly is no more.

Direct sunlight lands on a distinct tanning bed, leading to a 12-year-old cilantro named PARSLEY leaping out of it.

|              |                        |
|--------------|------------------------|
| RAU (CONT'D) | PARSLEY                |
| IS MY SUN!   | MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD! |

**END OF "MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD"**

RAU (CONT'D)  
Turn around... You missed a spot.  
But son, do you shine...

PARSLEY turns around.

PARSLEY  
*Me (Vietnamese: "Mom")*... Don't  
embarrass me in front of the  
sneezeworts!

Patrons are planting their faces on the door of Salontro.

RAU  
Us Cilantros are all about  
presentation. Parsley Răm is a  
natural. Organic. Woodwork.

RAU holds PARSLEY's green hands.

**ACT I**

**INT. SALONTRO - DUSK**

RAU has PARSLEY sit on a tanning bed. She clips PARSLEY's hair.

RAU  
But your trichomes getting  
unnaturally long.  
(Repeating and  
interspersing)  
I love you. I love you lots.

PARSLEY  
(Repeating and  
interspersing)  
I love you. I love you more.

RAU  
How many trims are needed for all  
the love?

PARSLEY  
Odd... Mom... For once, please no  
math-

RAU  
What is the airspeed velocity of an  
unladen dandelion seed?

PARSLEY  
Thirty centimeters per second. Last  
math probl-

RAU  
Thirty seconds. Square root of a  
boxwood tree?

PARSLEY  
I'll learn square roots when I  
start middle school in the fall.

RAU has PARSLEY face a mirror.

RAU

Is this worthy of a Flores  
Elementary graduate?

PARSLEY

Gym class would have a good laugh.

RAU

With this cut, they'd actually pick  
you before the Cherries.

PARSLEY

Dodgeball is an Apple's sport  
anyways.

RAU

*You need your root canals checked.*  
Speaking of Apples, how was class  
before the ceremony?

PARSLEY

Fruitful! Ms. Red's partner stopped  
by.

RAU

That's delightful. Who is he?

PARSLEY

Her name is Golden Delicious. She  
is an archaeologist.

RAU

Oh, *she* is... *She*...

PARSLEY

Ms. Red's final lesson was that Fig  
weddings are more fabulous than any  
other kind.

RAU

Schools should not be teaching  
minors that! Schools should be  
teaching kids major subjects, like  
if Florida schools teach math and  
science.

PARSLEY

History!

RAU

Here's a story: seedlings exist  
only because stamens and pistils  
love one another.

PARSLEY

A kid at recess once told me that  
love is like the legendary tale of  
the bird and the bee.

RAU

Kids fall for so many rumors these  
days. Plus, those don't add up.  
Birds and bees don't go together.  
It's bird plus bird. Bee plus bee.

Dance music distantly echoes, so PARSLEY perches by the  
window.

PARSLEY

Ugh, math. Something's buzzing at  
FigLeaf.

RAU

The Figs are hosting another party.  
You can always count on that.

RAU uses a tanning bed as a desk to do taxes and count money.

PARSLEY

Mom... Who goes out at night?

RAU

A light with no sense of direction,  
son.

PARSLEY

But the sound sure likes going our  
way.

RAU

Sounds don't feed us.

PARSLEY

A light with no sense of  
direction... So, there is light.  
They are just lost.

RAU

Their light is artificial. They  
chose not to follow what is  
natural.

PARSLEY

But our tanning beds... Its light  
don't come from the sun?

RAU

*They paint skins with UV. It is like if you split the spectrums of sunlight onto a palette.*

PARSLEY

What is a spectrum?

RAU

I don't know... But don't ask Malus. Malus...

PARSLEY & RAU

Has malice intent.

RAU

Figs are the root cause of identity and social norms' instability.

PARSLEY

I know... But they have society's money. And money is the root of all evil-

RAU

Sure, he and his customers paid our rent for a while. But we paid off our plot of land. Salontro is independent of FigLeaf.

PARSLEY

Yet, Salontro still depends on FigLeaf.

RAU

Depends on the years to come.

PARSLEY

We would go under without them.

RAU

We will never overturn our views for them.

PARSLEY

You see new business models everyday.

RAU

Well, their B S are unnatural.

PARSLEY

*Yeah, the money's unreal.* What's natural to you?

RAU  
Biodiversity like your class of  
plants. It makes for a healthy  
garden.

PARSLEY  
What makes more diversity?

RAU  
Less homogeneity.

PARSLEY  
Homo-

RAU  
Figs need more sun on their skins.  
Sons in their lives. My parents had  
a son once. He once set things  
straight. Until he no longer isn't  
and so couldn't.

PARSLEY  
Malus is like the Woodworkan unty  
we need.

RAU  
Don't say such nonsense. Back to my  
point: the sun's what grooms all  
things...

"A NATURAL" SONG

RAU (CONT'D)  
NATURE...  
NURTURED FROM THE LIGHT OF OUR SUN.  
IT'S NATURAL.  
  
PLANTING THEIR HOT FEET ON OUR  
GROUND.  
THEY'RE NATURAL.  
BUT IT'S NOT AS WARM AS A MOM'S  
HUG.

RAU hugs PARSLEY.

RAU (CONT'D)  
COMES NATURAL.  
WHAT'S NOT? THAT WOULD BE THE  
TICKLES!

RAU tickles PARSLEY.

RAU (CONT'D)  
(Repeating)  
A NATURAL... IS TRUE TO THEMSELVES.  
SON. YOU ARE A... NATURAL!

**END OF "A NATURAL"**

PARSLEY  
Will the sun always be around?

RAU  
The sun will never turn over to the  
dark side.

PARSLEY  
What about during an eclipse?

RAU  
What? *You're talking like those  
Venus flytraps.*

PARSLEY  
Ms. Red taught us that the moon can  
sometimes get in the sun's way.

RAU  
The moon sounds unnatural... Anywho  
like you, even the sun has a  
bedtime.

PARSLEY  
Ugh.

RAU opens a tanning bed and plants a blanket in it.

RAU  
Your planter is made. Now go lie in  
it.

PARSLEY points at the outlet.

RAU plugs in a nightlight.

PARSLEY lies in bed.

PARSLEY  
*I am a natural at lying.*

RAU  
You speak the truth, my son.

PARSLEY  
Mom. I wonder who'll be my moon...

RAU  
*Ngu ngon* (Vietnamese: "Sleep  
well"), my son.

RAU exits.



**EXT. SALONTRO - DUSK**

The sun sets behind Salontro.

**EXT. MT. WOODWORK - DAWN**

The sun rises behind Mt. Woodwork, a rural town in the upper peninsula of the state of Woodwork.

**EXT. PYRUS'S HOUSE - DAWN**

In view, there is a tree-like house and a pond.

**INT. PYRUS'S BEDROOM - DAWN**

It is a teenager's bedroom, full of posters and musical instruments. The 14-year-old pear named Pyrus is the ruler of this domain.

BOMBUS, a pet bee, is sleeping on PYRUS's face, covering them completely. Once the sunlight encroaches on BOMBUS, they start buzzing like an alarm.

BOMBUS  
Buzz! Buzz! Buzz! Buzz!

PYRUS  
Buzz... off!

PYRUS throws BOMBUS into their hive bed. PYRUS is tired.

**INT. PYRUS'S BATHROOM - DAWN**

PYRUS looks in the mirror. PYRUS is disheveled, whose face is full of teenage acne and mind is full of teenage angst.

**INT. PYRUS'S LIVING ROOM - DAWN**

On the table are stacks of envelopes and letters that detail PYRUS's multiple suspensions from school and their mother's letter to their unty Malus about staying over the summer.

**EXT. PYRUS'S POND - DAWN**

PYRUS dives into the pond and goes for a swim. They hear nature judging them.

NATURE  
(Repeating and echoing)  
You will never amount to  
anything...

PYRUS soon runs out and sobs. BOMBUS rushes to their side. Their antennae wipes away PYRUS's tears.

**EXT. PYRUS'S HOUSE - SHORTLY AFTER**

A bus waits in front of the home. PYRUS comes out with their luggage. They wave goodbye to BOMBUS watching from a window.

PYRUS takes a seat in the bus and sees BOMBUS partying in PYRUS's bedroom. PYRUS looks on, disapprovingly.

And on the bus goes.

**WOODWORK**

A map of the state of Woodwork is displayed. It is reminiscent of Michigan, the writer's home state. The upper peninsula resembles the tree leaves while the lower peninsula resembles the trunk of the tree.

PYRUS's bus is going from Mt. Woodwork in the upper peninsula to Dirty City in the lower peninsula.

**EXT. DIRTY CITY - DAY**

The bus drives by the welcome sign of Dirty City.

**INT. SALONTRO - DAY**

RAU is physically arguing with a delivery person. The delivery person barges out. PARSLEY is cleaning the salon then notices a bus slow down and stop by FigLeaf. PYRUS steps off the bus. RAU steps in front of PARSLEY's sight.

RAU

The delivery messed up. I'm going out to get it.

RAU exits. PARSLEY looks back at the bus driving away.

PARSLEY (V.O.)

The delivery is not messed up...  
I'm going out to meet them...

MALUS enters Salontro.

MALUS

Where's your mom?

PARSLEY

Our latest shipment was delivered to the wrong address. So, she's out getting it.

MALUS

Strange. She's usually out to get me. I kid, you Cilantro. Nevertheless... Cow, Parsley.

PARSLEY

*Chào*. You Crabapples are always sweet, but you can never sweeten your pronunciations?

MALUS

*I'm a certain bi, not bilingual.*

PYRUS (O.S.)

No, Malus. / No malice.

MALUS

Yes, Pyrus!

PARSLEY

Pyrus?

MALUS

My nibbling.

PARSLEY

Another Crabapple?

MALUS

The pear's in town.

PYRUS (O.S.)

And I wanna get outta this Dirty City.

PARSLEY

Doing our city dirty? You'll fit in real well.

MALUS

Tanning beds come in all shapes and sizes. And there gotta be one dat matches your body, Pear.

PYRUS (O.S.)

I don't want nobody to see me around ya, crazy unty Apple. Let's go back to FigLeaf!

PARSLEY

I always wanna visit FigLeaf.

MALUS

Now, you may have the spirit of a Fig. But only adult plants are allowed at nightclubs. And, *your mother would lose her freakin' aldehyde.*

PYRUS (O.S.)

Ya said ya'd take me to Cantaloupe Outlets, not make this salon my outlet...

MALUS

You will never find me among those  
hipsters. How about a trip to  
Celery Mall?

PYRUS (O.S.)

But ya said we could go where I  
wanted! You're more of an Apple  
Blossom than a Crabapple. Celery  
Mall only sells to old houseplants.

MALUS

Take dat back!

PYRUS (O.S.)

Per FigLeaf's policy: No returns.  
No, Malus.

MALUS

Nothing's returnable in a  
nightclub, Pyrus... You're digging  
a deeper hole for yourself.

PYRUS (O.S.)

Ain't dat what we're supposed to do  
as plants?!

MALUS

Even plants can get overheated.

PARSLEY

You're all making a mountain out of  
a molehill.

PYRUS (O.S.)

Shadeeee. Ya can burn us. But, ain't  
nothing can top a sunburn.

**"AMOUNT TO ANYTHING" SONG**

PYRUS walks in with sunburns and green palms. Their entrance  
is like a teenage rocker with acne. They knock over the  
potted herb.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

MOUNTAINS OUTTA MOLE HILLS.  
NO REST. DISTRESSED. A MESS.  
CARELESS.

I DELIVERED BRUISES AND I GOT INTO  
TROUBLE AT SCHOOL.  
SO, I'LL SPEND THIS SEASON WITH MY  
ONE WEIRD UNTY.  
I WON'T KNOW MALUS...

(MORE)

PYRUS (CONT'D)

ALL BECAUSE REALLY  
I WILL NEVER AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.  
I WILL NEVER AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.  
I WILL NEVER AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.  
ANYTHING!

PYRUS (CONT'D)

SUNBURNS. PIMPLES. ACNE. BIG DEAL.

I AIN'T ALWAYS THIN-SKINNED, BUT MY  
THICK SKIN HAS NOT LOOKED REAL  
COOL.  
SO, I'LL WASTE MY SUMMER NEXT TO A  
CILANTRO.  
I CAN'T GIVE A MORSAL...

ALL BECAUSE IN LIFE,  
I CARE NOT TO AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.  
I CARE NOT TO AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.  
I CARE NOT TO AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.  
I DON'T CARE!

ANYTHING!

**END OF "AMOUNT TO ANYTHING"**

PYRUS (CONT'D)

I just wanted a good tan...

MALUS

And you can get it here.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

A *natural* tan!

MALUS (CONT'D)

We're not the only families  
susceptible to sunburns. The  
Cherrys and Maples are, too.

PARSLEY

Our tanning beds can be set at any  
level most comfortable with you.

MALUS

See, Pyrus. Parsley's always level-  
headed.

PYRUS

I'm gonna level with ya Cilantros:  
ya can spice up my skin, but it  
ain't ever spice up my life.

(to MALUS)

Don't look at me. I'll meet ya back  
at FigLeaf.

MALUS

Ya seedlings enjoy yourselves!

MALUS exits.

PYRUS

I ain't no seedling anymore, Malus!  
Do ya thing, little herb.

PARSLEY leads PYRUS around the tanning beds in Salontro.

PARSLEY

High pressure tanning beds?

PYRUS

I ain't letting no middle schooler  
pressure me.

PARSLEY

No pressure at all. Where do you go  
to school?

PYRUS

Tetra High Conservatory.

PARSLEY

THC, in the U P? That school's rich  
enough to not have a resource  
officer.

PYRUS

Eat poop with ya *lower peninsula*  
*mindset*... Trolls under the bridge.  
Right, it ain't stop other flowers  
from being fashion polices.

PARSLEY

What did these upper peninsula  
Yoopers do?

PYRUS

They get under my membrane. They  
overreacted.

PARSLEY

To...?

PYRUS

Me shutting down the school's power  
grid... So they ain't look at me no  
more.

PARSLEY

My classmates would think you're  
loads of fun!

PYRUS

What do middle schoolers even do  
for fun?

PARSLEY

Mudwrestling and singing in the  
rain!

PYRUS

I'm not sure what to make of it.  
Fun or not, in the end, I'm the one  
who shuts the party down.

PARSLEY

A rose and thorn for you.

PYRUS

Don't get me started on the roses.  
They are mean and the brighter  
fashion police.

PARSLEY

How?

PYRUS

They go beyond outer body shaming.  
Their thorns reach my core. My  
nucleus.

PARSLEY

Your nucleus needs to toughen up.

PYRUS

My nucleus needs to grow thorns,  
like them.

PARSLEY

You pears need to stop comparing  
yourself to others.

PYRUS

Easy for ya to say. Ya haven't gone  
through puberty yet, little herb.

PARSLEY

You'll grow out of anything. It's  
all dandy.

PYRUS  
Wow, rich coming from a middle  
school poop head.

"GROW A PAIR" SONG

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
YA NEED TO GROW UP.

PARSLEY  
TWO CAN PLAY AT THAT GAME!

PYRUS  
YA AIN'T CRAP.

PARSLEY  
I AM THE CRAP.

PYRUS  
YA ARE

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
A NUMBER TWO.

PYRUS  
GROW UP, HERB.

PARSLEY  
GROW UP, PEAR!

PYRUS  
I NEED TO GROW ONE?

PARSLEY  
YOU GOT SKIN IN THEIR GAMES.

PYRUS  
I AIN'T THICK.

PARSLEY  
HIGH SCHOOL AIN'T CRUD.

PYRUS  
I NEED

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
TO FACE THE HEAT.

PYRUS  
STOP COMPARING...

PARSLEY  
GROW A PAIR.

PYRUS gets into a tanning bed. After the magic, they get out.

PYRUS  
HERB... THIS AIN'T NATURAL.  
DUDE! I FEEL POWERFUL.

PARSLEY  
YOU PEARS.

PYRUS  
I AM STILL GROWING.

PARSLEY  
WE BOTH NEED TO GROW UP.

PYRUS  
CILANTROS.

PARSLEY  
AND CRABAPPLES.

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
WE DO MAKE A GREAT

PARSLEY PYRUS  
TEAM. SMOOTHIE.

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
NOT SO SMOOTH...

PARSLEY  
LET'S GET SOME FOOD!

PARSLEY shares fertilizer popsicles with PYRUS.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)  
HERE'S TO GROWING UP!

PYRUS  
FERTILIZER NEVER...?

PARSLEY  
GETS TOO OLD!

PYRUS  
DEFINITELY!

PARSLEY  
YOU KNOW WHAT IS COOL IS THAT

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
WE'D MAKE A GREAT PAIR.

END OF "GROW A PAIR"

PYRUS pulls out a glass bottle.

PYRUS  
Let's test our water.  
(Scaring PARSLEY)  
Alcohol's only fifteen percent...

PARSLEY  
I can't drink that.

PYRUS  
Why not?

PARSLEY  
I'm not old enough.

PYRUS  
I ain't either. But I'm fine. *I feel old enough.* And I'm like only a few years older than ya. Besides, this is worth 72 B S. You're old enough to count dat high?

PARSLEY  
You don't need to spew much. Look, it's on me. If you feel bad about it, I'll take a few bull.

PYRUS  
Nah, I need to save every B S I can, so I can finally cut off my carbon-dated parents.  
Ya heard my life with the flowers at school. Now imagine dat but 72 times dat at home.  
Just a sip. You'll feel right at home.

PYRUS opens the bottle.

PARSLEY takes a sip. He spits out.

PARSLEY  
It's a *miracle* I got any taste of barley piss.

PYRUS  
Dat's the name of the liqueur!

PARSLEY  
Barley piss?

PYRUS

*Ewwwww, no. Miracle! Well, looks like our friendship is gonna go against the grain.*

PARSLEY

Friends?

PYRUS

Miracle and I, silly herb! And now dat we're friends, friends go shoppin' together!

PARSLEY

Can Miracle tag along?

PYRUS

*Miracle needa stay a no-show or we'll be tagged as criminals by the po-po. Don't start poop!*

PARSLEY

Wash your mouth out with soap!

PYRUS

Wash yours with Miracle! I'm rooting for ya, Parsley.

PYRUS takes the bottle. They exit.

### "TEST THE WATER" SONG

PARSLEY enters this newfound state of tasting alcohol for the very first time. The lake forms. The tides rise. PARSLEY wobbles. He stays put and yet also journeys to far-off lands. He breaks in his sea legs. He slowly passes out.

PARSLEY

(Repeating)

Glucose is clear... Glucose is clear...

### End of "TEST THE WATER"

### **INT. SALONTRO - LATE NOON**

RAU enters with a box of body oils. She goes to help PARSLEY up.

RAU

Have you got any pride, son?! Get up, it's "pride" month! Today is our pride special!

PARSLEY  
(Dizzily)  
Did you get the goods, mom?

RAU  
Good grief, son...?

PARSLEY  
(Dishonestly)  
*I may have caught a fungal  
infection.*

RAU  
I dab antifungal ointment on you  
everyday... Now's not the day to  
sell yourself short. Speaking of  
infection...

RAU dons some rainbow gear. She stops PARSLEY from wearing  
them.

Multicolor patrons rush the space.

PARSLEY  
Fun guys all around! Happy Pride!

RAU  
*Happy Pride!* Get thirty-one percent  
off your order when you wear  
Salontro merch at checkout! Buy our  
rainbow gear! Parsley... Upsell  
these by sixty-nine percent. Sell  
sell sell!

PARSLEY  
Made from the bees' knees, these  
body oil will do more for you this  
Pride Month. At just several B S  
more than our plain oils, your  
knees will be buzzing in no time.  
(Leveling with a child)  
Kids and short knees like me get a  
discount!

RAU  
You're indoctrinating the kids?!

The patrons stop moving.

RAU (CONT'D)  
Don't count your blessings,  
Parsley... Um...  
(to the Patrons)  
(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)

In trade, kids need to be treated as adults. Discounts are handouts. And we're unlike other businesses who refuse to serve you and take your B S. Although, *it is allowed under national law*. Here at Salontro, we'll always support your unnatural lifestyles.

The lights flicker in disapproval.

PARSLEY

*You were born this way!*

The multicolor lights move about.

RAU

*That quote always work. Happy Pride! Love your fit. Happy Pride! So floral. Happy Pride! Tis the season for a gay apparel. Happy Pride! Thank you for supporting small business owners. Happy Pride! Immigrant family-owned business. Happy Pride! That looks so natural on you!*

As the products run out, PARSLEY turns the "Open" sign to "Closed."

RAU (CONT'D)

Son, at the center of every rainbow is green. These Figs and their B S are unnatural! *Happy Pride...*  
Hahahaha!

RAU trashes her rainbow gear. She counts money.

PARSLEY

Geez, mom. Get a room! You're more tender to legal tender than your own son! It's unnatural.

RAU

Unlike you, I don't pocket it! I donate all this B S to non-profits, like Moms for Canopy.

PARSLEY

They got nothing better to do than to bully my classmates and ban our books... *Poop heads!*

RAU

Where did you learn to say those  
*foul words?!*

PARSLEY

You need to lower the volume  
whenever you watch your boring tv  
show at night.

RAU

Don't you dare say that about *Green Lotus*. By the way, why were you  
sleeping on the job? I'm going to  
garnish your wages.

PARSLEY

You're gonna make my allowance  
fabulous?

RAU

No... Though, *your joke is a garnish in itself.*

RAU sees the knocked over herb.

RAU (CONT'D)

Is this some kind of joke?! No no  
no... Why is my brother knocked  
over?

PARSLEY

That is not a person...

RAU

Yes, he was!

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

That is a model.

RAU (CONT'D)

Yes, he was a modelled plant, *until*  
*he hung out with the Figs.*

PARSLEY

My uncle?

RAU

*Anh* (Vietnamese: "Brother"). He  
would have laid off the booze...

PARSLEY

Booze?

RAU

His addiction to Figs led to the  
booze which laid him off from work  
and society. He was the light of  
our lives that went dark too soon.

PARSLEY

Did my grandparents do anything to  
stop it?

RAU

They did their darneest to protect  
him from the unnatural. He was a  
person 'til he became a Fig.

PARSLEY

There's nothing your parents  
could have done.

RAU (CONT'D)

I'm already a better parent  
than they ever were.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

*A better parent would let me get  
some rest.*

RAU

Okay. You've been laid off.

PARSLEY

I need a vacation.

RAU

Where would you like to go?

PARSLEY

Cantaloupe Outlets.

RAU

That trashy Woodworkan shopping  
center? Well, we can stop by and  
grab some ingredients at their  
intimate Vietnamese supermarket.

PARSLEY

You like the butcher?

RAU

Someone's got to split water into  
oxygen. Besides, he and I are just  
old friends.

PARSLEY

I made a new friend...

RAU

Is it a classmate from Ivy League Junior High? Son, you're finally making friends! Name?

PARSLEY

Pyrus.

RAU

Where are *they* from?

PARSLEY

The town of Woodwork in the Upper Peninsula.

RAU

Pyrus is coming out of *the* Woodwork...

PARSLEY

And they made Salontro their first visit!

RAU

Did *they* try out a tanning bed? Ooh, which one?

PARSLEY

All of them.

RAU

Wow. In town for a day and already our number one customer.

PARSLEY

Yes. And I wanna get to know our number one customer at the business of all businesses: Cantaloupe Outlets.

RAU

Why can't you be friends with the Cruciferous?

PARSLEY

Ew... Those family of Broccolis are lame.

RAU

What is your two's plan at Cantaloupe Outlets?

PARSLEY

We're gonna go see *Popcorn*.

RAU

Oh no. That movie is for adults.  
And besides, I don't need you to  
have nightmares about what heat  
does to corn. It's not a pretty  
sight...

PARSLEY

*There's no kernel of truth in what  
you said.*

RAU hands money to PARSLEY.

RAU

Here's twenty B S for *VeggieTales*.

PARSLEY

*Shucks. You are so corny-*

RAU

Their fanbase is hard to tolerate.  
That reality show is a religion to  
them. But, they know what's natural  
and not.

(Quoting a *VeggieTales*  
song)

"GIVE ME THAT OLD TIME RELIGION."

PARSLEY

God, you don't even believe in a  
higher farmer-

RAU

Well, the gospel music...  
"IT'S GOOD ENOUGH FOR ME."  
Gravity created the Universe. The  
food court is pricy, so I packed  
carbon and a watering can.

Godspeed. Now, go get yourself  
ready as a plum.

RAU hands a food container and a watering can to PARSLEY.

PARSLEY hides in a tanning bed. The other tanning beds  
disappear.

## **ACT II**

**EXT. CANTALOUPE OUTLETS - DAY**

The tanning bed turns into a photo booth. Clothing racks scatter. PARSLEY sits inside the photo booth as PYRUS enters and joins in.

**"PHOTOSYNTHESIS" SONG**

PARSLEY  
GET YOUR BUTT IN THE PHOTO BOOTH.  
WE'RE GONNA TAKE A LITTLE BREATHER.

PYRUS  
BREATHE IN, BREATHE OUT.

PYRUS drinks from a watering can.

PARSLEY  
MAKE SURE THAT YOU STAY HYDRATED.  
WE'RE GONNA DRINK LOTS OF WATER.

PYRUS  
H 2 O.

PARSLEY  
NOW GET YOURSELF SITUATED.  
WE'RE GONNA MAKE TONS OF SUGAR.

PYRUS  
SWEET MEMORIES.

PARSLEY  
SIX CARBON DIOXIDE!

PYRUS  
AND PLUS...  
SIX WATER MOLECULES.

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
PUT IT UNDER LIGHT.

|                         |                          |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| PARSLEY                 | PYRUS                    |
| C 6                     | SUGAR,                   |
| H 12 (TWELVE)           | SUGAR,                   |
| O 6...                  | SUGAR,                   |
| PLUS 6 O 2.             | AND STARCH.              |
| GLUCOSE,                | 6 CARBON                 |
| GLUCOSE,                | 12 HYDROGEN              |
| GLUCOSE,                | 6 OXYGEN...              |
| AND STARCH.             | PLUS 6 OXYGEN MOLECULES. |
| THIS IS PHOTOSYNTHESIS. |                          |
| PHOTOSYNTHESIS.         | CARBOHYDRATE!            |

PARSLEY pulls many ingredients.

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
YOU'RE OVERREACTING.

PARSLEY  
I WANNA GOOD PRODUCT.

PYRUS  
YOU'LL GET BYPRODUCTS.

PARSLEY PYRUS (CONT'D)  
BI...? SUGAR RUSH!

PARSLEY and PYRUS dance the sweetest of dances.

|                  |                |
|------------------|----------------|
| PARSLEY (CONT'D) | PYRUS (CONT'D) |
| SUGAR,           | C 6            |
| SUGAR,           | H 12 (TWELVE)  |
| SUGAR,           | O 6...         |
| AND STARCH.      | PLUS 6 O 2.    |

|                          |                 |
|--------------------------|-----------------|
| 6 CARBON                 | YOUR CELLULOSE. |
| 12 HYDROGEN              |                 |
| 6 OXYGEN...              | YOUR CELLULOSE. |
| PLUS 6 OXYGEN MOLECULES. |                 |

|               |                           |
|---------------|---------------------------|
|               | WE WRITE: PHOTOSYNTHESIS. |
| CARBOHYDRATE! | PHOTOSYNTHESIS.           |

The space displays the equation:  $6CO_2 + 6H_2O \rightarrow C_6H_{12}O_6 + 6O_2$ .

PARSLEY and PYRUS hand juices to patrons around the mall.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

C 6  
H 12 (TWELVE)  
O 6...  
PLUS 6 O 2.

6 CARBON  
12 HYDROGEN  
6 OXYGEN  
PLUS 6 OXYGEN MOLECULES.

PHOTOSYNTHESIS.  
PHOTOSYNTHESIS.  
PHOTO!

The photo booth flashes and prints a photo of a cilantro and pear.

PARSLEY and PYRUS exit the booth.

**END OF "PHOTOSYNTHESIS"**

The MAYOR strolls in and out, sipping the juice.

MAYOR

Mayor Canna Blomquist here to remind you: sugar and water are a privilege, not a right for green card holders.

PYRUS

We needed dat breather. Redoing the photo scene in that movie was so much fun! Good thing it was rated PG-12, little herb.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

*Rotten Tomatoes* is the all-time greatest movie!

PYRUS

It deserves to win the Raspberries.

PARSLEY

I'd certify that it was *freshhhh*.

PYRUS

Well, I hate the scene where despite the kids' fruits of labor, they ended up diced tomatoes.

PARSLEY

Can I have another sip of Miracle?

PYRUS tucks away a hidden bottle.

PARSLEY stays put with a sour face.

PYRUS

It was hard enough hiding this bottle in a dark theatre. Don't expect me to pass it in broad daylight. Quit the sour face, sour grapes. No whining about wine either.

PARSLEY

You're as square as diced tomatoes...

PYRUS

Oh, I'm the square?!

There is a mannequin in queer fashion with heels and a crop top. PARSLEY and PYRUS mock one another until they run into the mannequin.

MAYOR

Watch out for the mannequin!

Huh? PARSLEY

PYRUS

*Looks like you're the square.*

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

I'm no square...

PYRUS

Just checking. Boobs come in all shapes and sizes. Go ahead. Milk this moment, little herb.

## PARSLEY

Aren't these for...?

PYRUS

They're not just for flowers like me. But these would be perfect for our summer solstice rave!

PARSLEY

## What's a rave?

PYRUS

A party where everyone smells like Asparaguses.

PARSLEY

I wanna go! But Malus is gonna be there...

PYRUS

It'll be the summer solstice. Malus will be going on their annual camping trip.

PARSLEY

## Who's in charge?

## PYRUS

Mari, our security guard.

PARSLEY

Juana? Haha. They always sleep on the job.

PYRUS

They know better than anyone else  
how to get through the day. I  
'dress them as ya "highness."

PARSLEY

In that case, your highness: Raves  
are for me!

PYRUS

I'm gonna lay down some *ground*  
*rules*.

PARSLEY

"Ground rules" sounds like another  
song!

PYRUS

No time. Rule number one: no kids  
allowed.

PARSLEY points to himself.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

Bedtime's dusk. No kid can handle  
all nighters.

PARSLEY

The night is short during a summer  
solstice!

PYRUS

I still don't think ya can, little  
herb.

PARSLEY

You're not so big either.

PYRUS

Well, the music is gonna be for  
little big flowers like me. We have  
a famous guest DJing.

PARSLEY

What's their name?

PYRUS

It's a secret. But the DJ certainly  
loves shouting their name at the  
top of their stomata to start a  
song. Such a weird vegetable.

PARSLEY

Pyrus, is this half-shirt the key to  
adulthood?!

PYRUS

Only if ya can top mine!

"CROP TOP" SONG

PYRUS wears a crop top.

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
(Repeating)  
NOW, IT'S YA TURN.  
PICK A PATTERN.

PARSLEY soon picks a t-shirt.

PYRUS nabs and drops the shirt.

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
NO NO. RETURN!  
  
THE CREAM OF THE CROP DAT IS  
FASHION.  
NO SHIRT CAN EVER TOP THIS!

PARSLEY reads the crop top tag.

PARSLEY  
A CROP TOP...?

PYRUS  
WHERE TO FIND ONE DAT FITS?  
WEAR ONE DAT SUITS YA PERSONALITY.

PYRUS plays with their belly.

PARSLEY  
THERE GOES YOUR BELLY.

PYRUS  
YA CANNOT BE STOPPED WHEN YA PUT  
YOURSELF IN THIS CROP TOP!

PYRUS puts a crop top on PARSLEY.

PARSLEY  
IT FEELS SO WARM YET SO COOL...

PYRUS  
IT CUTS TO YA HEART'S BOTTOM.  
IT HAS YA FEELING ON TOP!  
YA CANNOT BE STOPPED WHEN YOU'RE  
DANCING IN ROCKING CROP TOPS!

PARSLEY  
I TOP YOURS!

PYRUS  
YA BOTTOM FEEDER!

PARSLEY  
I'M ON TOP!

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
I'LL CROP YOU!

PYRUS chases PARSLEY around. The mannequin becomes the mirror reflection of PARSLEY. PARSLEY sees the mirror reflect the queer plant he could truly be someday.

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
YOU'RE THE TOP OF THE CROP TO TOP  
IT ALL OFF!

PARSLEY  
(Blushingly)  
NO ONE PULLS THEM OFF LIKE ME...

PARSLEY, PYRUS, and the mannequin suit up in their crop tops.

PARSLEY & PYRUS & MAYOR  
CROP TOP!

The mannequin phases into PARSLEY.

**END OF "CROP TOP"**

**EXT. CINEMA AT CANTALOUPE OUTLETS - DAY**

MALUS runs out of the cinema at Cantaloupe Outlets while RAU tails MALUS. She holds a popcorn bucket filled with water.

RAU  
You cropped my profits!

MALUS  
See a prophet about your problems.  
Quit stalkin-

RAU  
Salontro has lost stock of 72 B S  
worth of UVA lamps due to short-  
term excessive use.

MALUS  
Apply for seed funding from  
grassroots orgs!

RAU  
Immigrant-owned businesses are less  
likely to be approved for seed  
funding than others.

MALUS  
You pick data like a Cherry.

RAU

I am not cheery about these  
maintenance costs!

MALUS

Why don't you appreciate what's  
afforded to you, you transplant!

RAU

I'm no trans, Fig.

MALUS

*Let's transition away from the  
topic.* It ain't the end of the  
world like dat disaster movie, *Soil  
and Green*. What we just watched:  
*Popcorn*. Ah, such cinema! Nothing  
can change my mind about that foxy  
eggplant cameo, oh honey.

RAU

Don't honey me, *honeycrisp critic*.

MALUS

You're no film critic. Why are you  
here?

RAU

Well not to talk business. I dropped  
my son off.

MALUS

And you stayed to get into  
Parsley's business?

RAU

You have no business going to the  
movies alone.

MALUS

I was dropping my nibbling off.  
Then, I needed a half-baked  
blockbuster to clear my mind about  
watching over a teenager this  
entire summer.

RAU

Someone's got to pop the thought of  
what it is like raising children  
into your aldehyde-

RAU finds and picks up the potted photo by the photo booth.

PARSLEY

I'm down to go... But I'm not up  
for that rave.

PYRUS

Nothing can top this. You'll be  
ready for it.

MALUS

Love dat reminder dat I've done  
everything?

RAU & MALUS

We've been neighbors for years  
in...

RAU

Business.

MALUS

Home.

RAU & MALUS

(Disingenuously)

I trust you.

RAU

(re: the photo of PARSLEY  
and PYRUS)

Looks like my brother when he was  
younger...

MALUS

Don't bring up dat tragic story  
again.

RAU

I cared for him as your sister  
cares for you.

MALUS

Aww... A photosynthesis of my nib  
and your kid-

RAU

Parsley told me that a seedling  
stopped by and use all our tanning  
beds. *It was your species.*

MALUS

Horse poo!

RAU

They tanned and dashed.

MALUS

I loaned- I mean gave them enough  
to cover seven appointments... You  
sure your Parsley didn't stash the  
B S?

RAU

How could you frame my son?

MALUS

Picture this: they're about a  
teenager now, growing into  
adulthood, and their top priority  
is B S. Like all teenagers!

RAU approaches PARSLEY and PYRUS.

RAU

Son, I'm gonna crop your top off!

PARSLEY

*Me (Vietnamese: "Mom")?!*

RAU

The plants around this outlet are  
watching a Cilantro make a scene.  
Pull it off now!

MALUS

You're the Cilantro always making a  
scene, Rau.

(Complimentary)

You're pulling off dat crop top,  
Parsley.

PYRUS

This little herb is on top of the  
world. His plot is going places.

RAU

*Im lang, đồ vô học (Vietnamese:  
"Shut up, you uneducated person")!*

MALUS

Parsley, whatcha mom say? I ain't  
heard this insult before.

PARSLEY

*Me... (Vietnamese: "Mom") You're  
the ignorant one. Con đĩ  
(Vietnamese: "Insult")!*

MALUS

(to RAU)

*Look at you foaming at your stomata mouth!*

PYRUS

Ha! Whatever ya said. I can't believe ya said it. Ya son of a-

RAU slaps and drags away PARSLEY.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

You jerk...

RAU

(Heartbroken)

*Thang chỗ đê* (Vietnamese: "Son of an insult")... Uh, Malus is the *thang chỗ đê* whose family tree is shaped like a circle. End this scenery at once!

PYRUS

I'm rooting for ya, Parsley!

PARSLEY

Mom. As you've said: "A natural is true to themselves."

RAU

(Mad as a Vietnamese mother)

A natural?! You're not true to yourself. What you and Pyrus are doing... It is unnatural!

**"SOILED (THE FAMILY NAME)" SONG**

RAU (CONT'D)

ARE YOU OUT OF YOUR ALDEHYDE?  
WHY CAN'T YOU LEAVE THE PUBLIC'S EYE?  
WILL YOU LEARN YOU'RE NEVER RIGHT?  
DON'T YOU EVER EVER LIE!

PARSLEY

CAN I LIVE WITHOUT HAVING TO HIDE?  
MAY I MAKE MY BED WHERE I DECIDE?  
DO I HAVE ANY SORT OF RIGHTS?  
TIL THEN, I WILL ALWAYS LIE!

RAU

I won't let you lie six inches under like your uncle!

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)

YOU ARE GROUNDED FOR LIFE!

TOY WITH ME  
AND I WILL FEED YOU TO PESTS.  
YOU BURY OUR KIN IN SHAME,  
AND YOU WILL MEET OUR ANCESTORS IN  
DEATH!

SOIL OUR NAME  
AND I WILL RAIN HELLFIRE!  
YOU HAVE NO ONE ELSE TO BLAME.

ARE YOU LISTENING, PARSLEY RĂM?  
I'M SO TIRED...

MALUS hugs PYRUS.

MALUS

I AM SO PROUD!

NO RESPECT.  
SHE HAS NONE AS SHE IS FAKE.  
SHE'S THE ONE WHO SOILED HER NAME,  
MAKING OTHER IMMIGRANTS LOOK LIKE  
SNAKE PLANTS!

PARSLEY

How did "Parsley" slither into your  
mind?

If you did not want me to conform  
to the ecosystem, why did you give  
me a Workworkan name like  
"Parsley?!"

Me, *soil the family name*... Who was  
it that didn't give me a foreign  
name like you, Rau?!

RAU

*Anh thanh niên* (Vietnamese: "Young  
man"), "gay."

PARSLEY

*Young men* cannot stay grounded!  
Thanks for the validation. I am no  
longer a seedling. Gay. *Happy*. I  
don't want it any other way.

RAU

YOU ARE A CRIME.  
DON'T MAKE ME CRY.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

I'M AT MY PRIME.  
I FEEL LIKE DY-

RAU (CONT'D)  
(Repeating)  
YOU SOILED...

MALUS  
(Repeating)  
IN THE NAME...

PARSLEY  
(to RAU)  
IN THE NAME OF FAMILY, I GAVE  
YOUR LIFE SOIL!

MALUS (CONT'D)  
(to PYRUS)  
IN THE NAME OF FAMILY, YOU  
GAVE OUR LIVES SOIL!

PARSLEY hides in the photo booth.

MALUS buys the crop top and exits.

**END OF "SOILED (THE FAMILY NAME)"**

RAU  
We're soiled inside...

PYRUS  
Get outta his personal space, ya  
invasive species-

RAU  
You've got some xylems calling me  
that! Pyrus... Who taught you to  
address me this way?

PYRUS  
Malus says ya are who ya are.

PYRUS exits.

RAU looks upon her plain hands.

RAU  
(Soliloquizing)  
This Dirty City needs to know: I  
love my seed. I know the future can  
stem more from these new  
opportunities than anything my past  
roots have offered me. I don't want  
the money. I need the green card  
that comes with it. But, dealing  
with the Figs' B S must not be the  
only way. I wither witnessing my  
son be a daisy rather than staying  
sturdy.

Parsley sees freedom with each  
passing dawn. Cori Anh, my brother,  
had the same sights. Free will  
quenched his insatiable thirst,  
then drowned him in his final dusk.

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)

His so-called "brothers in branches" encouraged this. If only the biochemicals, the conversion therapy had shocked him out of his truth!

This time, I am taking care of it as a sister-turned-mother. I don't got to worry about how my life will play out because I'll play games night and day. But my son, playing with these creatures of the night, will soon find himself never again seeing the light of day. Unlike his uncle, I will save him from the Fig life style full of pain and heartache. I'm sick to my stoma, thinking about a life so unnatural.

This Dirty City wishes for me to stop being invasive. Only if your Figs would stop invading my nerves and my son's heart. Now pay no mind.

RAU exits.

The photobooth transforms into a bed and the outlet into Salontro.

**INT. SALONTRO - NIGHT**

**"FERTILE" SONG**

The tanning bed holds a soiled blanket, where PARSLEY pops out.

PARSLEY

THE WORLD REVOLVES AROUND MORE THAN  
YOUR SON.  
WHY CAN'T YOU SEE THAT?  
AN HERB WHO NEEDS THEIR PLANT  
FRIENDS.  
PLANET, TOPPED OFF WITH CROPS AND  
VEGETABLES.  
YOU DON'T SEE MY PRODUCE-  
IT IS TRULY FUTILE.

IN THIS "SOILED" FAMILY,  
I AM MEANT TO GET DIRTY, REAL  
DIRTY.  
HOW ELSE WILL I EVER BEAR FRUIT?  
I AM FERTILE.

(MORE)

PARSLEY (CONT'D)  
VOLATILE!

FIGLEAF WOULD NEVER DEFER MY SMILE.  
A CLEAR COMMUNITY WHO WOULD ACCEPT  
ME AND ALL...  
THE WHILE MOM KILLS ME TO PUT IT  
MILDLY.  
THIS WILL BE MY TRIAL.  
I'M WILDER THAN A CHILD.

AM I TO SNEAK OUT?  
MY MAMA...  
THIS WILL NOT HELP ME COME CLEAN,  
WITHOUT MEANS.  
MY DROP WILL NOT BE SO FRUITFUL.

PYRUS  
IT AIN'T FUTILE!

PARSLEY looks out the window. PYRUS is outside.

PYRUS (CONT'D) PARSLEY  
LET'S GET WILD! RECONCILE!

PYRUS (CONT'D)  
YOU BELONG IN AN OPEN FIELD.

PARSLEY  
I LONG FOR WHAT'S QUEER AND  
ANYWHERE SO SURREAL.

PYRUS tosses a crop top to PARSLEY.

PYRUS  
WEAR THIS BEFORE IT GOES OUT OF  
STYLE.  
YOU HAVE MADE ME REALIZE: IN LIFE,  
IT IS NEVER FUTILE...

PARSLEY trashes his nightlight. He climbs out of the window.

PARSLEY  
I AM FERTILE!

**END OF "FERTILE"**

### **ACT III**

**INT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - NIGHT**

PARSLEY lands by PYRUS on the dirt.

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
We got a Cilantro in da yard!

PARSLEY  
And we got a Cauliflower... on  
guard?

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
Not just a Cauliflower. *The*. DJ...

DJ CAULIFLOWER holds a microphone towards the patrons.

"DIRT ON YOU" SONG

PARSLEY  
Holy sneezeworts. It's DJ...

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
What are you all, houseplants?! You  
know who I am, Dirty City! We gotta  
act like weeds all up in dis  
cement. Me, I'm a godsend...

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)  
WE DA BEST...

PYRUS  
WE ARE BEST...

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
WE DA BEST...

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
WE ARE BEST FRIENDS!

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)  
WE DA BEST HOUSEPLANTS!

PARSLEY  
IT'S DJ...?

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
IT'S DJ...

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
DJ CAULIFLOWERRRR!

PYRUS  
I love this song!

PARSLEY  
Which one? DJ Cauliflower starts  
every song like-

PYRUS  
Don't make me squash ya into pesto,  
Cilantro.

(MORE)

PYRUS (CONT'D)

LET'S GET DIRTY!  
LET'S GET DIRTY, PARSLEY?

PARSLEY  
YOU GET DIRTY, PYRUS.

PYRUS  
PLEASE GET DIRTY WITH ME.

PYRUS drags PARSLEY to the dance floor.

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
LET'S GET DIRTY!

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
YOU: I GOT, I GOT DIRT  
ON YOU, ON YOU.  
YOU GOTTA LOTTA NERVES COMING HERE.

PYRUS hands liqueur to PARSLEY, which he incrementally drinks.

PARSLEY  
WITH YOUR B S!

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
YOU: I GOT, I GOT DIRT  
ON YOU, ON YOU.  
YOU... I'M KEEPING MY EYES ON YOUR

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)                      PARSLEY & PYRUS  
DIRTY SOIL!                                      FILTHY SOIL!

PARSLEY  
LET'S GET DIRTY!

PYRUS  
YA SO DIRTY TO ME!

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
Y'ALL GET DIRTY!

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
YOU: I GOT, I GOT DIRT  
ON YOU, ON YOU.  
YOU... I'M KEEPING MY EYES ON YOUR  
DIRTY SOIL!

The lake forms. The tides rise.

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
DO NOT MESS AROUND BECAUSE MY ROOTS  
ARE IN DA UNDERGROUND.  
(MORE)

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)  
IF YOU STUCK AROUND, WE'LL HAVE  
YOUR STEMS MAKING MUDDY WET SOUNDS.

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
ROOT FOR ME  
AND WATER ME!

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
SOIL ME!

Give me dat freaking money!

PYRUS makes money rain.

PARSLEY  
Money screwed over my mom!

PYRUS  
We're screwing every adult in Dirty  
City!

PARSLEY  
What's dirty?

PYRUS  
Dirty City... Where ya live? Are ya  
drunk...?

PARSLEY  
I never felt so aliveeee!

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
Dat little herb is on their own  
little island!

Rainstorms brew. The stormy ocean descends and washes PYRUS  
away. A lighthouse appears. PARSLEY's sea legs break. His  
fears swallow him.

PARSLEY  
CAN A, CAN A PLANT DROWN?

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
IF WATER REACHES OUR STEMS, WE IN  
TROUBLE.  
WHEN DA BAR AIN'T YOURS, TIME  
BEHIND BARS IS DOUBLED!

PARSLEY  
DOUBLED?!

PYRUS (O.S.)  
I NEED YOU...  
YOU NEED TO...  
(MORE)

PYRUS (O.S.) (CONT'D)  
I NEED TO...  
I NEED TWO BARS OF REST!

DJ CAULIFLOWER stops the music as PYRUS searches in blinding light.

PYRUS (CONT'D) PARSLEY  
Parsley! Parsley! Py- Pesto-

PARSLEY pukes. DJ CAULIFLOWER resumes the music.

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
Dat's real dirt, did someone get  
dat on tape?

The lighthouse turns into cameras.

PYRUS  
Malus is my unty! Ugh. You're good  
as dirt, hanging out with all the  
grapes.

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
Excuse me. All my hype men are  
homemade! Now, someone compost dat  
on all social medias!  
  
DO NOT MESS AROUND BECAUSE MY ROOTS  
ARE IN DA UNDERGROUND.  
NOW YOU'VE STUCK AROUND, WE'LL HAVE  
YOUR STEMS IMPOUND, IMPOUND,  
IMPOUND!

PYRUS reaches PARSLEY.

The cameras morph into ambulances.

PYRUS  
DIRT'S ON YA...

PARSLEY  
AND DIRT'S ON YOU...

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
CALL DA COPS!

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
COPS?!

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
YOU: WE GOT, WE GOT DIRT  
ON BOTH OF YOU.  
YOU GOTTA LOTTA NERVES DRINKING  
HERE.

PYRUS  
THIS IS BULL CRAP!

PYRUS throws money all about. They drag away PARSLEY.

The ambulance lights morph into police lights and sirens.

DJ CAULIFLOWER  
YOU: WE GOT, WE GOT DIRT  
ON YOU, YOU, YOU...  
TWO... ARE NOT ABLE TO WIGGLE

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)                      PARSLEY & PYRUS  
YOUR WAY OUTTA DIS!                      THERE'S DIRT ON US!

Handcuffs are audible.

End of "DIRT ON YOU"

**EXT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - LONG AGO**

**"FIG LEAF" SONG**

Shadows are present, reminiscent of the Vietnam War era.

MALUS (V.O.)  
A tree's lifetime ago, in the  
suburb of Dirty City by the banks  
of Lily River, there birthed an  
Apple named Malus. Their birthday  
was on the winter solstice, the  
shortest day of the year known as  
the founding of FigLeaf.

Dat was an extraordinary day. My  
parents kicked me out. I laid naked  
on the concrete, freezing to death.  
An Orange found me. They sheltered  
me here in this nightclub. Figs  
flocked from all over the world to  
meet this miracle.

But something stark happened: a  
Cilantro walked into the bar. A  
post-traumatic memory revisited the  
Orange. The Orange was an agent who  
fought in the war on the Cilantro's  
home turf. Orange faced endless  
horrors as swarms of herbs stood  
their ground despite the chemical  
fires. Orange gave me their deed  
and left into the moonlight.

(MORE)

MALUS (V.O.) (CONT'D)  
I used to eclipse my light. I once  
hid my life. FigLeaf gave me the  
might to show my light. I require  
the cross pollinations of the bees  
and bees... They bequeath me queer  
peace.

I live for the science of FigLeaf.  
With sugar and water, I took over  
its forces of nature. I, however,  
did not teach Pyrus to respect it.

As was the winter solstice the birth  
of FigLeaf, the summer solstice is  
the end of FigLeaf.

**END OF "FIG LEAF"**

**EXT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - PRESENT**

RAU drags in MALUS and slaps them. She cannot find the words.

MALUS  
You've lost the plot. *Thang chó đe*  
(*taun cha deh; Vietnamese: "Son of*  
*a insult"*). Dat's me.

RAU  
Face the consequences of not  
looking after Pyru-

MALUS  
You face it. It's in your  
chlorophyll. Your kind spilled red  
blood. Your family is invasive.

RAU  
*Invasive?! You deranged- Annoying*  
*orange-*

MALUS  
Don't compare Crabapples to  
Oranges! Pyrus said Parsley was as  
yellow as the sun. The hospital's at  
least making sure he ain't end up in  
the sky.

RAU hands some money to MALUS.

MALUS (CONT'D)  
This ain't fixing the *blues*.

RAU

This will at least fix the bill for  
all the *indigo* cocktails my Parsley  
didn't pay for.

MALUS

This is some B S, you shrinking  
*violet*.

RAU

The *greens*. Doesn't that solve  
everything?

MALUS

Don't put it on me to answer to you  
anymore.

RAU

Then put it on the house-

MALUS

There won't be a house.

RAU

It's you who lost the plot...? Not  
FigLeaf...

MALUS

Dirty City is shutting us down.  
They got *proof*.

RAU

In the liqueur pumping out my son's  
stoma...

MALUS

Underage drinking... Perpetrated-  
Encouraged by my blood. Why didn't  
my nibling card your kid?

RAU

That pear hasn't earned their adult  
card, yet.

MALUS

And you ain't ever earned any of  
yours!

RAU

I get it: my earnings are zero-

MALUS

Get it to your aldehyde: look  
beyond the green B S and B S cards.

RAU

Parsley will wither as my brother  
and I have.

MALUS

You bring him up every time you  
want to pretend to relate to Figs  
cause you had a gay brother. There  
ain't a thing you can do for the  
dead.

RAU

Hmm. What do you have to say for  
your sister?

MALUS

FigLeaf was the chance to get her  
child out of trouble and make their  
plot feel whole.

RAU

FigLeaf is now a plot hole... But,  
I do recall a Fig who once sang:  
*"move the plot forward."*

MALUS

Move the plot forward, not move my  
plots out. You took my job away.  
Invasive species-

RAU

What's left to say, *houseplant*?

MALUS

Dirty City's verdict was right.  
Immigrants come here to take away  
our jobs, homes, and lives.

RAU

They got dirt on both of us!

MALUS

Being queer or foreign ain't the  
same struggle. Do not plant us in  
the same patch of soil.

RAU

You Crabapples did it first for us.

MALUS

Spare me the details.

RAU

It is on me to pass on to you the  
card up my sleeve. We're more in  
common than you can ever imagine.  
It comes with revoking our  
greens...

12. "GREEN CARD"

MALUS

YOU WERE LAYING ON MY YARD...  
THEY HAD LEFT YOU STARVING.  
I SHOULD'VE KEPT MY GUARD  
BEFORE YOU KILLED MY GREEN CARD!

RAU

I HOLD A REAL GREEN CAR-

MALUS

IM LANG ("EEM LAUNG")!  
  
YOUR WORDS WILL NOT GO SO FAR...  
THEY SHOULD HAVE JUST BARRED YOU.  
I USED TO STOP SPARS.  
NOW, THEY WENT AND CLOSED MY BAR!

RAU

SORRY.  
I DESERVE NO GREEN CARD.  
I HAVE SERVED YOU ENDLESS  
SCARS.  
WHICH IS BY FAR NATURALLY  
QUEER AS YOU ARE.

MALUS (CONT'D)

YOUR HAND DESERVES A BAD CARD.  
THEY SAW YOU AS JARRING.  
YOU ARE UNNATURAL.  
YOU'LL NEVER CHANGE WHO YOU  
ARE!

MALUS (CONT'D)

'SCUSE ME?

RAU feels the potted herb.

RAU

BROTHER...

Leaves fall from above, and land in RAU's hand.

RAU (CONT'D)

The new leaves- The next generation  
will turn this world upside down  
for the better.

RAU (CONT'D)

YOU AND PYRUS CAME SO FAR...  
THEY CAN STILL GET STARTED.  
I NEED TO GROW SMART.  
MY TURN TO HAVE A HEART.

MALUS

YOU ARE GOING TOO FAR.  
MY PYRUS IS A REAL STAR.  
IMMIGRANTS NEVER SETTLE  
FOR LOW MARKS.

RAU (CONT'D)  
REPORT CARDS, BUSINESS CARDS,  
DON'T GET ME STARTED ON CREDIT  
CARDS.  
TAKE THEM ALL!  
THE TAKEAWAY IS THAT GREEN CARDS  
ARE EARNED...  
I MUST WATER OUR COMMUNITY.  
IT'S THE LEAST I CAN DO.

**END OF "GREEN CARD"**

MALUS  
You took away my rights.

RAU  
They almost took my son's life.

MALUS  
Pyrus gave your son life.

MALUS hands the photo of the pear and cilantro to RAU.

RAU  
Malus, you gave me life.

MALUS  
You took away my livelihood.

RAU  
You can start over.

MALUS  
The queer community I built?!

RAU  
You can always hide it under your  
soil. And wait to reveal yourself  
when the light is right.

MALUS  
So hide in the soil again is what  
you saying?

RAU  
Many plants want the chance to  
start over. To turn back into the  
seeds.

MALUS  
Save your false wisdom in the  
closet.

RAU

I have every politician in my closet.

MALUS

More like skeletons- Wait, what?

RAU

*Same thing.* Representatives from across the nation come to Salontro. When they get comfortable, they'll tell me anything.

MALUS

Elaborate...?

RAU

Remember that "Morning Wood" scandal on WoodTV8?

MALUS

From Loyal Oak, the city over?

RAU

Their mayor shorted me. So, I was the anonymous tip who revealed their adultery on the news station's live Q&A with Mayor Pumpkin Eater.

MALUS

And *cheater Pumpkin Eater* resigned. So for you, *politics be nasty*. You Cilantros are indoctrina-

RAU

I also built relationships with the investor and management community, grooming returns based on the size of their emotional transactions.

MALUS

Sick. You've got dirt on everyone. What about the council in our hometown?

RAU

Dirty City did me dirty. They lined my pockets with tax cuts. But, they won't do more. *Though, I got neighboring cities in my pockets for you!*

MALUS

I don't matter. Pyrus does. Pyrus is going to be in bigger trouble without me in the plot.

RAU

I'm moving Pyrus's plot forward.

MALUS

There's the usual backwards reasoning you do.

RAU

I'm giving back to a lost soul what you've gave this lost immigrant. I've held everyone back. I'm a houseplant...

MALUS

*You're a transplant.*

RAU

I'm a transplant...

MALUS

A plant who transforms...

RAU

A plant who transforms...

MALUS

The environment around them...

RAU

The environment around me...

MALUS

You do not belong on this soil. But your blood altered the chemistry of it, so that Pyrus can feel even more welcomed. Your son changed them.

RAU

Parsley got a new friend, too... My parents tried to stop my brother Cori from changing with his circle. Cori Anh Der crawled through the mud, so that Parsley can trail ahead.

MALUS

A young Cilantro once said: "mud is where you're most safe."

MALUS unveils mud underneath. An olive branch hangs. RAU hugs MALUS.

RAU  
A real friend's here when the B S  
hits the fan.

MALUS  
Hey... Where did this olive branch  
come from? You hug like a tree  
hugger. Dat is so gay.

RAU humorously detaches.

RAU  
Take my money. You'll need it more  
than I do. Huh... Will I ever earn  
my green card?

MALUS  
Dat's not for us geezers to decide.

RAU  
That's for the...

RAU & MALUS  
Second generation of seedlings.

RAU  
Malus, go out there and save  
another Cilantro!

MALUS floats off into the sunrise.

RAU (CONT'D)  
I knew it, I knew it: Figs are  
angels.

RAU finally plants herself. She buries her hands in the mud.  
She transforms, pulling out her palms now drenched in green.  
RAU has earned her green card.

RAU (CONT'D)  
YOU ARE... A NATURAL.

**EXT. SALONTRO - DAY**

Business is dead. The place is an allegory for a dead  
houseplant.

RAU looks inside the cash register and pulls out a single  
bill.

PARSLEY (O.S.)  
Can I turn the sign to "open?"

RAU  
I'm open for business. You are not.  
Stay in bed.

PARSLEY (O.S.)  
At least I'm in a bed, not a  
coffin. Like that joke, mom? *Me*  
(*Vietnamese: "Mom"*)...

RAU  
*Me* (*Vietnamese: "Mom"*) as in "meh"  
or "me?"

PARSLEY (O.S.)  
Vietnamese words are funny.

RAU  
Especially Vietnamese plants.

PARSLEY (O.S.)  
Mostly the Cilantros's musical  
taste.

RAU  
Hey. Wash your mouth out with soap.

PARSLEY pops out of a tanning bed, holding soap.

PARSLEY  
(to the camera)  
Raise your appendages if we,  
Cilantros, taste like soap!

PARSLEY hands soaps to the camera.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)  
This is your next meal. Let me know  
if we really taste like that.

RAU  
You talking to nobody and wasting  
our soap does not make a good case  
for you being "well."

PYRUS (O.S.)  
And I have a bad case ahead of me.

PYRUS enters. Their skin holds minor burns.

RAU  
Pyrus... In the flesh.

PYRUS

I certainly don't look fresh, Ms.  
Răm.

RAU

Summer's coming to an end. But  
there's light at the end of the  
tunnel as you return to school.

PYRUS

I need school, so I don't end up a  
"đồ vô học" ("dough vo how"; Viet:  
"An uneducated person").

PARSLEY

*Me* (Vietnamese: "Mom"), you're the  
one who needs to be educated.

RAU nods in agreement.

PYRUS

Sorry for calling ya an invader.

RAU

I'm sorry to invade your space.

PYRUS

Enlighten me.

RAU

There is more to darkness than  
meets the eyes.

PYRUS

FigLeaf was the only light in the  
nightlife.

RAU

I'm sorry your unty has to start  
over.

PYRUS

I'm glad he helped you get started.  
It's ya turn to give Malus the  
tips.

RAU gives PYRUS the last money bill.

RAU

I'll give you one: to my son, say  
good-

PYRUS

Goodbye. I know... *Good riddance?*

RAU

Goodness gracious. Have something good to say. Stop being the root cause. Be the root effect.

PYRUS

Little herb... I... Sor-

PARSLEY

Breathe in, breathe out... Um, 6 carbon... 12 hydrogen... 6 oxygen...

PYRUS

Plus 6 oxygen molecules...

PARSLEY & PYRUS

Photosynthesis. Photosynthesis. Photosynthesis! I will always root for you.

PYRUS

I will never amount to anything. I won't mount a proper apology. But for once, I do care. This is despair. Don't look at this pear.

PARSLEY

You always amount to everything.

PYRUS hands a crop top to PARSLEY.

PYRUS

Don't puke on this one, okay?

PARSLEY

And don't let the flowers bully you!

PYRUS

Ah, another school year at THC. I'll climb high on a mountain.

RAU

I'm sorry things worked out the way they did. But you can. Make sure you grab a tax form on your way out!

As MALUS had done for RAU, RAU moves a plot of land for PYRUS.

PYRUS

Taxes?

RAU

You must pay the government B S to work.

PYRUS

What you're saying is a load of B S.

RAU

Well, you're old enough to intern. And that B S you pocketed is your first paycheck.

PYRUS

Why?

RAU

I owe your unty.

PYRUS

I'd probably get the salon shut down, too.

PARSLEY

Oh shut up, poop head.

**"TURNOVER (A NEW LEAF)" SONG**

PARSLEY hugs PYRUS.

PYRUS

I'd be supervised by *dat*? I'll clean dat dirt in ya mouth, ya sweetgrass.

RAU

Finally, someone else up for the task.

PYRUS

I cannot thank you enough, Ms. Răm.

RAU

It's my *turn* to help you start over.

PARSLEY

You're welcome back any time!

RAU

With Malus's intent, there's always a plot for you here.

RAU opens a colorful tanning bed, where PYRUS sits.

MALUS gets out of another tanning bed. They watch as PYRUS gleams. There are hints they opened a new nightclub called "Fig Garden."

MALUS  
TURN AROUND!

Business is booming again with patrons coming in and out.

PARSLEY & PYRUS  
WE HAVE CHANGED THEM.  
TURN OVER PAIRS OF FRESH EYES.  
NEW LEAVES, COLORS.  
TURN OVER TO THIS STRANGE LIGHT.

RAU & MALUS  
LIGHT.

PARSLEY, RAU, PYRUS, MALUS  
THIS DIRTY CITY IS OUR HOME.  
THE NEIGHBORS, THEY'RE KNOWN  
TO HELP US TO SOW OUR SEEDS AND  
GROW...  
TURN OVER AND CHANGE FOR THE  
BETTER.

Water rains down.

|                               |                              |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------|
| PARSLEY & RAU                 | PYRUS & MALUS                |
| THIS IS THE SPARK OF...       | THIS IS THE SPARK OF...      |
| A FLORAL PARTNERSHIP.         | AN HERBAL PARTNERSHIP.       |
| A FRIENDSHIP WHERE I CAN REST | A FRIENDSHIP THAT LEAVES THE |
| OUR GARDEN.                   | BEST SHARED GARDEN.          |

PARSLEY and PYRUS turn the "Closed" sign to "Open."

PARSLEY, RAU, MALUS, PYRUS  
BUT THE BEST TURNOVER WE'VE HAD IS  
THE SUN!

A tanning bed opens with sunlight.

**END OF "TURNOVER (A NEW LEAF)"**

The MAYOR enters.

MAYOR  
(to the camera)  
We hope you enjoyed your stay in  
Dirty City. Now, let's let these  
plants bow to the light. Oh, *I get*  
*the last bow.* And before you return  
to your home garden, let's take a  
group photo!

**"BOW - PHOTOSYNTHESIS" SONG**

COMPANY  
PHOTOSYNTHESIS! PHOTOSYNTHESIS!  
PHOTO!

**END OF "BOW - PHOTOSYNTHESIS"**

Snap! The polaroid camera prints out a group photo.

Below reads the end title: **PHOTOSYNTHESIS**

**END OF THE PLOT**

**CREDITS**

**DEDICATION: DEDICATED TO HUE NGOC NGUYEN, PHOTOGRAPHER AND  
DAVID QUANG PHAM'S MOM.**

